Reactants and products

When a **chemical reaction** occurs, new substances are made. The substances that we start with are called the **reactants**. The new substances that are made are called the **products**. The properties of the products are different from the properties of the reactants.

We can describe what happens in a chemical reaction by writing a **word equation**.

reactants ⟶ products

The arrow means 'changes into' or 'goes to'. It also shows you the direction of the reaction, so that you do not mix up the reactants and products.

☞ **1** What do we call the substances that we start with? _____

2 What do we call the new substances that form after a chemical reaction has occurred?

_____

3 How can we describe what is happening in a chemical reaction?

_____

4 Rewrite each of the following statements to make it correct.

a The reactants are written on the right-hand side of the arrow in a word equation.

_____

b The products are the substances that we started with before the chemical reaction occurred.

_____

c We use an equals sign to represent 'goes to' when writing word equations.

_____

When hydrogen reacts with oxygen, water is formed. This reaction can be shown with the following word equation:

hydrogen + oxygen ⟶ water

5 Underline the reactant/s in red and product/s in blue.

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